

THE DENNISON ALD ELEMENTS

5 THE MOST DESIGN-FORWARD DROP OF THE YEAR

The Dennison ALD Elements in steel shows that a persuasive design idea need not depend on an expensive movement. Tiger's eye, lapis lazuli, onyx, and amazonite are cut into one jigsaw-like dial, then housed in Dennison's slim cushion case. The quartz calibre is entirely appropriate: It keeps the watch thin and allows the material and proportion to dominate. At an accessible price point, this is an obtainable, characterful object for judicious collectors.



REXHEP REXHEPI 2026 CHRONOGRAPH FLYBACK

6 THE INDEPENDENT WATCHMAKER

The increasing interest in independent watchmaking turns the spotlight back on Rexhep Rexhepi. The timepieces have a quiet, old-school quality with serious thinking underneath. At just 25, the designer started Atelier Akrivia in Geneva in 2012 and has steadily brought more of the work into his own workshops. The 2026 Chronograph Flyback is his first flyback chronograph under his own name, with a new in-house movement and jumping-minute counter. Rexhepi has also won the GPHG Men's Watch Prize twice, in 2018 and 2022.

BANGALORE WATCH COMPANY



7 THE INDIAN IMPRINT

The latest chapter in the country's horology story shows watchmakers developing a distinct and credible identity—like Bangalore Watch Company, which is beginning to give contemporary India a confident voice in horology. It produces automatic watches, with collections inspired by a modern view of India. Just six years old, it is neither a manufacturer yet, nor does it need to pretend to be one. At this stage, coherent design, sensible movement choices, reliable servicing, and long-term collector confidence matter far more. A credible independent brand is not defined solely by how much it produces in-house but by whether its design language is recognisable and capable of travelling beyond its home market.